Mara Neumann

Project Manager | Research & Funding Programs

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Professional profile

Project manager specializing in publicly funded research and digitalization. Eleven years connecting engineering teams, university partners and finance through structured delivery, reliable reporting and governance. Experienced in consortium proposals, funding compliance and turning complex requirements into clear plans and measurable outcomes.

Core expertise

Research project delivery • Public funding & grants • Budget control • Stakeholder coordination • Process improvement • Risk management

Professional experience

2021–present

Senior Project Manager

Rheinbogen Systems GmbH · Karlsruhe

- Manage six research and digitalization projects with a combined €2.4 million budget, aligning engineering, university partners and finance from consortium proposals to milestones and final reports.
- Prepare funding applications, milestone plans and audit-ready cost reports; secured €780,000 in approved funding across three successful consortium proposals.
- Introduced a shared project dashboard and monthly risk reviews, reducing overdue actions by 28% while improving visibility for sponsors and project leads.
- Facilitate workshops with up to 18 stakeholders in Karlsruhe, München and Strasbourg, turning technical discussions into agreed decisions and accountable next steps.

2017–2021

Project Coordinator

Westhafen Engineering GmbH · Mannheim

- Coordinated engineering change projects across product development, purchasing and production, maintaining integrated schedules for teams of eight to twelve people.
- Managed supplier documentation, tracked purchase orders and reconciled project costs; supported delivery of a €620,000 equipment modernization program on schedule.
- Standardized status reports and handover checklists, reducing repeated clarification requests and making responsibilities transparent across departmental boundaries.

2015–2017

Graduate Project Analyst

Elbwinkel Technology Services · Stuttgart

- Built Excel-based project cost models, prepared steering-committee material and maintained action logs for industrial digitalization initiatives.
- Mapped administrative workflows with process owners and supported rollout of a document management system used by 45 colleagues.

Selected projects

Connected Lab Network · 2023–2025

Multi-partner research collaboration involving an engineering SME and two university laboratories. Coordinated work packages, budget forecasts, partner meetings and reporting obligations across a €940,000 program.

- Delivered all five milestones on schedule and established a shared evidence register for technical results, procurement records and financial documentation.

Funding Operations Toolkit · 2022–2023

Designed reusable funding checklists, cost templates and reporting schedules for project leads. Connected eligibility checks with project setup to avoid inconsistent assumptions during delivery.

- Reduced reporting preparation time from five working days to three, with clear ownership for evidence gathering and budget reconciliation.

Production Data Pilot · 2019–2020

Coordinated a cross-functional pilot that connected shop-floor data with project reporting. Organized requirements sessions, acceptance criteria and practical training for production coordinators.

Education

2013–2015

M.Sc. Industrial Engineering & Management

Karlsruhe Institute of Technology

- Focus: technology management, operations and innovation. Master’s thesis on adoption of digital tools in engineering project teams. Final grade: 1.7.

2009–2013

B.Sc. Industrial Engineering

Hochschule Mannheim

- Focus: production systems, business administration and quantitative methods. Semester project on resource planning for a university research laboratory.

Professional development

PRINCE2 Practitioner · 2022 | Professional Scrum Master I · 2020 | Public funding and grant administration · 2023

Tools & languages

Tools MS Project, Jira, Confluence, Excel / Power Query, Power BI, SharePoint, Miro; working knowledge of SQL.

Languages German: native | English: C1 | French: B1.

Community involvement

Volunteer mentor, Karlsruhe Women in Engineering network · Since 2021. Support early-career engineers with project planning, stakeholder communication and structured preparation for professional presentations.